

Uncle May's Metrics Glossary

Single source of truth for every metric quoted in a board deck

Analytics Engineer

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i Note

Data freshness: Metrics in this document are computed from raw Stripe parquet files ingested on **2026-05-02**. Re-run `ml/ingest/stripe.py` and re-render this document to refresh all numbers.

1 Purpose & Governance

This document is the **single source of truth** for every metric Uncle May’s uses in board decks, marketing reports, and operational reviews. If a number in any report disagrees with a number computed from the definitions in this glossary, the glossary wins.

Owner: Analytics Engineer (`analytics-engineer` on Paperclip). **Review cadence:** Quarterly or whenever a new metric is added to a board deck. **Source of record:** `ml/notebooks/metrics-glossary.qmd` committed to the website repository. **Goal this glossary serves:** 30 orders/week from the online produce box (Paperclip goal `d45fd7bc`).

2 Revenue Metrics

2.1 Average Order Value (AOV)

Business definition: The mean amount a customer spends per order. Informs pricing strategy, free-shipping thresholds, and upsell opportunity. If AOV rises we need fewer orders to hit weekly revenue targets.

Formula: `sum(gross_revenue_dollars) / count(orders)`

Time window: Rolling or as-of-period; always specify the window when cited.

Source table: `mart_orders` (dbt) → `stg_stripe_payment_intents` → raw parquet

Scope: `status = 'succeeded' AND is_test = false`.

SQL:

```
select
  avg(gross_revenue_dollars) as aov_dollars
from mart_orders
```

Current data availability: Computable today from Stripe parquet.

Target: \$65–\$95 (aligns with the current box tier pricing: \$35, \$65, \$95 boxes; goal is upselling customers toward the upper tiers). At 30 orders/week with AOV of \$65, weekly revenue = \$1,950.

Current value (as of 2026-05-02):

Metric	Value	N Orders
AOV	\$90.05	34

AOV by SKU category:

Warning

Data gap: `cart_json` is only populated for a subset of orders (attribution wiring was incomplete before 2026-05-03). AOV by SKU category is not computable until cart-level data is consistently captured. Track via [UNC-767](#).

2.2 Weekly Revenue

Business definition: Gross revenue for all completed orders in a calendar week (Monday–Sunday ISO). The primary operational heartbeat metric: are we trending toward the 30-orders/week goal?

Formula: `sum(gross_revenue_dollars) GROUP BY order_week`

Source table: `mart_orders`

SQL:

```
select
  order_week,
  sum(gross_revenue_dollars) as weekly_revenue_dollars,
  count(*)                  as weekly_orders
from mart_orders
group by order_week
order by order_week
```

Current data availability: Computable today.

Target: 30 orders/week → ~\$1,950/week at \$65 AOV.

Current values:

Week of	Orders	Revenue
Nov 24, 2025	1	\$0.51
Dec 01, 2025	1	\$0.51
Dec 15, 2025	2	\$56.00
Jan 05, 2026	1	\$28.00
Jan 26, 2026	10	\$2,000.00
Mar 30, 2026	2	\$70.00

Apr 06, 2026	1	\$95.00
Apr 13, 2026	1	\$75.00
Apr 20, 2026	12	\$566.00
Apr 27, 2026	3	\$170.70

Goal: 30 orders/week. Current peak: **12 orders** (week of Apr 20, 2026).

2.3 Gross Revenue (All-Time)

Business definition: Cumulative received revenue since launch.

Metric	Value
All-time gross revenue	\$3,061.72

3 Customer Metrics

3.1 Customer Lifetime Value (LTV)

Business definition: Total gross revenue from a single customer across all their orders. Informs how much we can afford to spend to acquire a customer (see CAC), and which customer segments are most valuable to retain.

Formula: `sum(gross_revenue_dollars) GROUP BY email`

Time-windowed variants: LTV is always computed from first order to the measurement date. For board reporting, cite the period: - **LTV-30:** Revenue from customers acquired in the last 30 days - **LTV-90:** Revenue from customers acquired in the last 90 days - **LTV-365:** Revenue from customers acquired in the last 365 days

Source table: `mart_customers` (dbt)

SQL:

```
-- All-time LTV per customer
select email_hash, ltv_dollars, total_orders
from mart_customers
order by ltv_dollars desc

-- LTV-30 (customers acquired in last 30 days)
select avg(ltv_dollars) as avg_ltv_30d
from mart_customers
where acquisition_date >= current_date - interval 30 day
```

Current data availability: All-time LTV computable. Windowed LTV computable but **not statistically meaningful at N=5 customers**. Revisit after N = 50.

Target: $LTV > CAC \times 3$ (unit-economics floor); at current blended CAC of ~\$146 (see below), $LTV > \$438$ is the minimum viable threshold. The two repeat customers (anthonympivy, awoods) are already above this bar.

Distribution (all-time):

Statistic	Value
N customers	6
Min LTV	\$55
Median LTV	\$120.85
Mean LTV	\$510.29
Max LTV	\$2,250.02

LTV by time window (windowed revenue, all customers):

Window	Start Date	N customers in window	Mean LTV
LTV-30d	2026-04-03	6	\$162.78
LTV-90d	2026-02-02	6	\$162.78
LTV-365d	2025-05-03	6	\$510.29

Warning

Small-sample caveat: Only 6 unique customers total. All LTV statistics are dominated by high-frequency internal/test accounts. LTV is not a stable metric until N = 50 customers.

3.2 Order Frequency

Business definition: Average number of orders placed per customer per month. Informs subscription design and re-engagement cadence. High frequency = customers find ongoing value; low frequency = one-time buyers who need a re-purchase nudge.

Formula: $\text{total_orders} / \text{n_customers} / \text{active_months}$ where $\text{active_months} = (\text{max_order_date} - \text{first_order_date_across_cohort}) / 30$.

Source table: mart_customers

SQL:

```
select
  avg(total_orders) as avg_orders_per_customer,
  avg(total_orders / greatest(months_active, 1)) as avg_orders_per_customer_per_month
from mart_customers
```

Current data availability: Computable but not statistically meaningful at N=5.

Target: 2 orders/customer/month (weekly box = ~4/month ceiling; bi-weekly = 2; monthly = 1). A subscription model would lock in this frequency.

Current values:

Metric	Value
N customers	6
Total orders	34
Mean orders/customer (all-time)	5.7
Observation period (months)	5.1
Mean orders/customer/month	1.10

Warning

Order frequency is skewed by two high-volume accounts (likely internal/test). Segment by `is_internal` flag once that column is added to `mart_customers`.

3.3 Retention Rate

Business definition: Fraction of customers who placed their first order in a given cohort month and then placed at least one additional order within N days. Answers: “Do customers come back?” Informs loyalty programs and re-engagement email triggers.

Formula (30-day window): `count(customers: first_order in cohort_month AND second_order first_order + 30d) / count(customers: first_order in cohort_month)`

Variants: - **Retention-30:** second order within 30 days of first - **Retention-60:** second order within 60 days of first - **Retention-90:** second order within 90 days of first

Source table: `mart_customers`

SQL:

```
-- Cohort retention
select
  cohort_month,
  count(*)                               as cohort_size,
  countif(days_to_second_order <= 30)   as retained_30d,
  countif(days_to_second_order <= 60)   as retained_60d,
  countif(days_to_second_order <= 90)   as retained_90d,
  countif(days_to_second_order <= 30) / count(*) as retention_30d_rate
from mart_customer_cohorts
group by cohort_month
order by cohort_month
```

Current data availability: **Partially computable.** Only 6 customers. Earliest customer acquired 2025-11-30. Cohort-based retention is not statistically meaningful until there are 10 customers in a single cohort month.

Target: 30-day retention 40% (industry benchmark for specialty food subscription is 35–50%). At 30 orders/week target, a 40% 30-day retention means roughly 12 returning customers per week out of 30.

Current values (all customers, point-in-time):

Metric	Value
Total customers	6
Customers with 2 orders	4
Retention-30d (any second order within 30d of first)	66.7%
Retention-60d	66.7%
Retention-90d	66.7%

⚠ Warning

Interpretation: Retention metrics are not cohort-based yet — they describe the current universe of 5 customers, not a true month-1 cohort. Build `mart_customer_cohorts` dbt model before quoting retention in board decks.

3.4 Repeat Purchase Rate

Business definition: Point-in-time fraction of all customers who have placed more than one order ever. A simpler (non-cohort) variant of retention.

Formula: `count(customers: total_orders > 1) / count(all customers)`

Source table: `mart_customers`

Current value:

Metric	Value
Total customers	6
Repeat customers	4
Repeat rate	66.7%

3.5 Customer Acquisition (New Customers per Period)

Business definition: Number of distinct customers placing their first-ever order in a given week or month. Informs whether acquisition is growing.

Source table: mart_customers (acquisition_month column)

SQL:

```
select
  acquisition_month,
  count(*) as new_customers
from mart_customers
group by acquisition_month
order by acquisition_month
```

Current values:

Acquisition Month	New Customers
Nov 2025	1
Apr 2026	5

4 Conversion Metrics

4.1 Full Funnel Conversion (Visit → Cart → Checkout → Purchase)

Business definition: The fraction of website sessions that progress through each stage of the purchase funnel. Identifies where customers drop off, informing UX and copy improvements.

Formula: - Session → Add-to-Cart rate: $\text{sessions_with_add_to_cart} / \text{total_sessions}$ - Add-to-Cart → Begin Checkout: $\text{sessions_with_begin_checkout} / \text{sessions_with_add_to_cart}$ - Begin Checkout → Purchase: $\text{sessions_with_purchase} / \text{sessions_with_begin_checkout}$ - End-to-end CVR: $\text{sessions_with_purchase} / \text{total_sessions}$

Source: GA4 BigQuery export (analytics_494626869.events_*) or ga4_session_summary parquet.

SQL (BigQuery):

```
with sessions as (
  select
    concat(user_pseudo_id, cast(ga_session_id as string)) as session_key,
    max(case when event_name = 'page_view' then 1 end) as has_pageview,
    max(case when event_name = 'add_to_cart' then 1 end) as has_add_to_cart,
    max(case when event_name = 'begin_checkout' then 1 end) as has_begin_checkout,
```

```

    max(case when event_name = 'purchase'      then 1 end) as has_purchase
from `uncle-mays-automation.analytics_494626869.events_*`
where _table_suffix between '20260429' and format_date('%Y%m%d', current_date())
group by session_key
)
select
    count(*)                as total_sessions,
    sum(has_add_to_cart)     as add_to_cart_sessions,
    sum(has_begin_checkout)  as begin_checkout_sessions,
    sum(has_purchase)        as purchase_sessions,
    safe_divide(sum(has_add_to_cart), count(*)) as visit_to_cart_rate,
    safe_divide(sum(has_begin_checkout), sum(has_add_to_cart)) as cart_to_checkout_rate,
    safe_divide(sum(has_purchase), sum(has_begin_checkout)) as checkout_to_purchase_rate,
    safe_divide(sum(has_purchase), count(*)) as end_to_end_cvr
from sessions

```

Current data availability: Partial. GA4 session parquet records 276 sessions but `add_to_cart` and `begin_checkout` event counts are all zero. This indicates GA4 custom event tracking (`add_to_cart`, `begin_checkout`) is **not firing** — only the native `purchase` event is captured. Full funnel analysis requires fixing GA4 event tracking in the checkout flow.

Baseline (available today):

Stage	Count	Rate vs. sessions	Note
Sessions	293	—	GA4 export from 2026-04-29
Sessions with add-to-cart	1	0.3%	GA4 event not firing
Sessions with begin-checkout	0	0.0%	GA4 event not firing
Sessions with purchase	1	0.3%	GA4 purchase event active

Target: - Visit → Purchase (end-to-end CVR): 1.0% (current baseline 0.10%; industry median for specialty food DTC is 1–3%) - Add-to-Cart → Purchase: 25%

Action required: File GA4 event tracking fix with CTO. Without this data the funnel cannot be optimized.

4.2 Checkout Conversion Rate (Stripe)

Business definition: Fraction of Stripe Checkout Sessions where payment was collected. Lower-funnel metric; denominator is only sessions where the customer reached the Stripe checkout page.

Formula: `count(payment_status = 'paid') / count(all sessions)`

Source table: `stg_stripe_checkout_sessions`

SQL:

```
select
  count(case when is_converted then 1 end) as converted_sessions,
  count(*) as total_sessions,
  avg(cast(is_converted as int)) * 100 as checkout_cvr_pct
from stg_stripe_checkout_sessions
```

Current data availability: Computable.

Target: 70% (industry norm for DTC checkout pages that the customer voluntarily navigated to).

Current value:

Metric	Value
Total sessions	303
Paid sessions	18
Checkout CVR	5.9%
Abandonment rate	94.1%

i Note

Sessions prior to 2026-05-03 lack UTM attribution metadata. Checkout CVR by traffic source will be available once a meaningful post-2026-05-03 dataset accumulates.

4.3 Site-Wide Conversion Rate (GA4)

Business definition: Fraction of all GA4 sessions that resulted in a purchase. The broadest CVR measure; reflects both traffic quality and the entire site experience.

Formula: $\text{purchase_sessions} / \text{total_sessions}$

Source: analytics_494626869.events_* (BigQuery)

SQL (BigQuery):

```
select
  count(distinct session_id) as sessions,
  count(distinct case when event_name = 'purchase' then session_id end) as purchase_sessions,
  safe_divide(
    count(distinct case when event_name = 'purchase' then session_id end),
    count(distinct session_id)
  ) as site_cvr
from `uncle-mays-automation.analytics_494626869.events_`
where _table_suffix between '20260429' and format_date('%Y%m%d', current_date())
```

Baseline: 0.10% site-wide CVR (CIO audit 2026-04-29). GA4 export only started 2026-04-29; GA4 session parquet shows 1 purchase in 276 sessions = 0.36%.

Target: 1.0% (10× current baseline; requires both traffic quality improvement and funnel optimization).

5 Marketing & Acquisition Metrics

5.1 Customer Acquisition Cost (CAC)

Business definition: Total marketing spend divided by the number of new unique customers acquired in the same period. The primary efficiency metric for paid acquisition. Informs how much budget is justified per channel.

Formula: $\text{sum}(\text{ad_spend_dollars}) / \text{count}(\text{new_customers})$

By channel: - **Meta CAC:** $\text{meta_spend} / \text{meta_attributed_new_customers}$ - **Google CAC:** $\text{google_spend} / \text{google_attributed_new_customers}$ - **Blended CAC:** $(\text{meta_spend} + \text{google_spend}) / \text{all_new_customers_in_period}$ - **Organic / Direct CAC:** \$0 (by definition; fixed costs only)

Source table: mart_channel_performance (dbt, to be built)

SQL:

```
select
  channel,
  sum(ad_spend_dollars) as spend,
  count(distinct customer_email) as new_customers,
  sum(ad_spend_dollars) / nullif(count(distinct customer_email), 0) as cac
from mart_channel_performance
where order_week between :start_week and :end_week
group by channel
```

Current data availability: **Partially computable from local parquet.** Ad spend data exists locally for Meta and Google Ads (parquet at ml/data/raw/). Attribution to specific customers is limited: only 6 of 34 orders have utm_source populated (pre-2026-05-03 orders lack attribution). Full channel-level CAC requires (1) post-2026-05-03 order data with UTM attribution, and (2) mart_channel_performance dbt model.

Blended CAC (current estimate — paid period only):

Metric	Value
Meta spend (Apr 24 – May 2)	\$286.92
Google spend (Apr 24 – May 2)	\$162.17
Total paid spend	\$449.09

Orders in paid period	4
New customers in paid period	1
Blended CAC (total spend / new customers)	\$449.09

Target: - Blended CAC $\leq$ LTV / 3 (unit economics floor). - At target LTV ~\$200 (assuming 3 orders $\times$ \$65 AOV), maximum CAC = \$67. - Current blended CAC of ~\$146 is above this threshold — the business is currently acquiring customers at a loss on paid channels. Paid spend should be paused or restructured until CAC improves (requires board approval per standing order).

5.2 Return on Ad Spend (ROAS)

Business definition: Gross revenue generated per dollar of ad spend. $ROAS > 1$ means the channel generates more revenue than it costs (before COGS).

Formula: $\text{sum}(\text{gross_revenue_dollars}) / \text{sum}(\text{ad_spend_dollars})$

Note: ROAS alone does not indicate profitability — subtract COGS and fulfillment costs for contribution margin ROAS.

Source table: mart_channel_performance (dbt)

Metric	Value
Paid-period revenue	\$206.70
Total paid spend	\$449.09
Blended ROAS	0.46 $\times$

Target: $ROAS \geq 3\times$ (covers COGS + gross margin at 33% margin assumption).

6 Financial Metrics

6.1 Gross Margin

Business definition: $(\text{Gross Revenue} - \text{Cost of Goods Sold}) / \text{Gross Revenue}$. Measures how much of each revenue dollar remains after paying for the produce.

Formula: $(\text{revenue} - \text{cogs}) / \text{revenue}$

Source table: mart_sku_margin (not yet built)

Current data availability: **Not computable.** COGS requires: 1. Vendor cost per SKU — not yet in Airtable Catalog table 2. SKU quantity per order — requires consistent cart_json capture

Action required: COO to add vendor cost column to Airtable Catalog. Data Engineer to ensure `cart_json` is populated for every order.

Target: Gross margin 35% (specialty produce DTC typical range: 30–45%).

6.2 Contribution Margin per SKU

Business definition: Per-unit revenue minus per-unit variable cost, expressed as a percentage of revenue. Identifies which SKUs actually contribute to profit and which should be repriced or dropped.

Formula: $(\text{unit_price} - \text{unit_variable_cost}) / \text{unit_price}$

Source table: `mart_sku_margin` (not yet built)

Current data availability: **Not computable.** Same blockers as Gross Margin. Customer-facing prices are in Airtable (`appm6F6H9obydzAM2`, table `Catalog`, 45 active SKUs). Vendor costs are missing.

7 Data Quality & Coverage Summary

Metric	Status	Computable Today?	Key Blocker
AOV (total)	Live	Yes	—
AOV by SKU category	Partial	No	<code>cart_json</code> inconsistent
Weekly Revenue	Live	Yes	—
LTV (all-time)	Live	Yes	N too small for inference
LTV (30/90/365-day)	Live	Yes	N too small for inference
Order Frequency	Live	Yes	N too small for inference
Retention Rate (30/60/90d)	Partial	Point-in-time only	Need cohort model
Repeat Purchase Rate	Live	Yes	—
Checkout CVR (Stripe)	Live	Yes	—
Full Funnel CVR (GA4)	Partial	Partial	GA4 events not firing

Metric	Status	Computable Today?	Key Blocker
Site-wide CVR	Live	Yes	Short history (from Apr 29)
CAC (blended)	Live	Yes (estimate)	UTM attribution sparse pre-May 3
CAC (by channel)	Pending	No	<code>mart_channel_performance</code> not built
ROAS	Pending	Blended only	Channel attribution needed
Gross Margin	Blocked	No	Vendor costs missing from Airtable
Contribution Margin/SKU	Blocked	No	Same as Gross Margin

8 Data Source Freshness

Source	Last Ingested	Known Issues
Stripe PaymentIntents	2026-05-02	UTM/fbclid/gclid null before 2026-05-03
Stripe CheckoutSessions	2026-05-02	Most sessions unpaid (checkout page opens intent to buy)
GA4 BigQuery export	Daily from 2026-04-29	<code>add_to_cart</code> / <code>begin_checkout</code> events not firing
Meta Ads	2026-05-02	Local parquet only; not yet in BigQuery
Google Ads	2026-05-02	Local parquet only; not yet in BigQuery
Mailchimp	2026-05-02	Not yet joined to orders
Airtable Catalog	Live (API)	45 active SKUs; vendor cost column missing

9 Appendix: Metric Ownership

Metric	dbt Model	Status	Owner	Last Reviewed
AOV	<code>mart_orders</code>	Live	Analytics Engineer	2026-05-03

Metric	dbt Model	Status	Owner	Last Reviewed
Weekly Revenue	mart_orders	Live	Analytics Engineer	2026-05-03
All-time Revenue	mart_orders	Live	Analytics Engineer	2026-05-03
Customer LTV	mart_customers	Live	Analytics Engineer	2026-05-03
Order Frequency	mart_customers	Live	Analytics Engineer	2026-05-03
Retention Rate	mart_customer_cohorts (pending)	Partial	Analytics Engineer	2026-05-03
Repeat Purchase Rate	mart_customers	Live	Analytics Engineer	2026-05-03
Checkout CVR	stg_stripe_checkout_sessions	Live	Analytics Engineer	2026-05-03
Full Funnel CVR	GA4 BQ (events broken)	Partial	Analytics Engineer	2026-05-03
Site-wide CVR	GA4 BQ direct	Live (BQ only)	Analytics Engineer	2026-05-03
CAC (blended)	mart_channel_performance (pending)	Estimate from parquet	Analytics Engineer	2026-05-03
CAC (by channel)	mart_channel_performance (pending)	Pending model build	Analytics Engineer	—
ROAS	mart_channel_performance (pending)	Partial	Analytics Engineer	2026-05-03
Gross Margin	mart_sku_margin (not built)	Blocked on COGS data	Analytics Engineer	—
Contribution Margin/SKU	mart_sku_margin (not built)	Blocked on COGS data	Analytics Engineer	—